

'ACT OF WAR'

Nation's worst terrorist attacks kill thousands



Photos by The Associated Press

With the two 110-story towers reduced to rubble, firefighters look for bodies or survivors Tuesday after attacks on the World Trade Center in New York City. In photos at top left, television footage shows a hijacked plane approaching and striking one of the towers. At bottom, workers and pedestrians on the streets below flee the smoke and ash billowing from the crumbling buildings. "The number of casualties will be more than most of us can bear," said Mayor Rudolph Giuliani.

Hijackers crash planes into the World Trade Center and the Pentagon in bold raids on the seats of finance and government.

By **JERRY SCHWARTZ**
The Associated Press

NEW YORK — In the most devastating terrorist attacks ever against the United States, knife-wielding hijackers crashed two airliners into the World Trade Center on Tuesday, toppling its twin 110-story towers. The deadly calamity was witnessed on televisions across the world as another plane slammed into the Pentagon, and a fourth crashed outside Pittsburgh.

"Today, our nation saw evil," President Bush said in an address to the nation Tuesday night. He said thousands of lives were "suddenly ended by evil, despicable acts of terror."

Said Adm. Robert J. Natter, commander of the U.S. Atlantic Fleet: "We have been attacked like we haven't since Pearl Harbor."

Establishing the U.S. death toll could take weeks. The four airliners alone had 266 people aboard and there were no known survivors. At the Pentagon, about 100 people were believed dead.

In addition, a firefighters union official said he feared an estimated 200 firefighters had died in rescue efforts at the trade center — where 50,000 people worked — and dozens of police officers were believed missing.

"The number of casualties will be more than most of us can bear," a visibly distraught Mayor Rudolph Giuliani said.

No one took responsibility for the attacks that rocked the seats of finance and government. But federal authorities identified Osama bin Laden, who has been given asylum by Afghanistan's Taliban rulers, as the prime suspect.

Aided by an intercept of communications between his supporters, and harrowing cell phone calls from at least one flight attendant and two passengers aboard the jetliners before they crashed, U.S. officials began assembling a case linking bin Laden to the devastation.

U.S. intelligence intercepted communications between bin Laden supporters discussing the attacks on the World Trade Center and Pentagon, said Utah Sen. Orrin Hatch, the top Republican on the Senate Judiciary Committee.

The people aboard planes who managed to make cell phone calls each described similar circumstances: They indicated the hijackers were armed with knives, in some cases stabbing flight attendants. The hijackers then took control of the planes.

At the World Trade Center, the dead and the doomed plummeted from the skyscrapers, among them a man and woman holding hands.

Shortly after 7 p.m., crews began heading into ground zero of the attack to search for survivors and recover bodies. All that remained of the twin towers by then was a pile of rubble and twisted steel that stood barely two stories high, leaving a huge gap in the New

"Today,
our nation
saw evil."

President Bush

FBI: Inadequate security left jets open to hijacking

● Investigators wonder how terrorists in different cities could take over the jets simultaneously.

By **RICHARD A. SERRANO**
and **DAVID WILLMAN**

Los Angeles Times

WASHINGTON — The air attacks Tuesday morning in New York and Washington and a jetliner crash in Pennsylvania were the work of a carefully orchestrated conspiracy that deftly skirted a beleaguered U.S. airport security system and placed terrorists on four separate planes, senior FBI officials believe.

Authorities suspect that the terrorists had help from airport ground crews, that they chose cross-country flights because the planes would be heavily loaded with

fuel and their ranks included hijackers who could fly planes.

But what investigators found most surprising was the timing. They marveled at how teams of hijackers working in at least three different cities simultaneously overpowered commercial planes in the air before federal authorities could shut down all flights across the country.

In doing so, the terrorists penetrated an airport security net that many had warned previously is inadequate.

Lewis Schilero, who as head of the FBI office in New York helped oversee investigations into the explosion aboard TWA Flight 800 and an earlier bombing at the World Trade Center, was left in utter disbelief by what he saw unfold Tuesday morning.

"I've been chilled by a lot of

Please see **HOW**, Page 9A

INSIDE

HOT LINES and HELP LINES

► **American Airlines**, hot line with information for family members of passengers, **1-800-245-0999**.

► **United Airlines**, hot line with information for family members of passengers, **1-800-932-8555**.

► **The American Red Cross** is holding a blood drive from 10 a.m. to 7 p.m. today at the Elks Club, 1945 Congress St. Volunteers are needed locally and also to travel to New York City to help. **Call 775-2367 or 1-800-GIVELIFE**.

Additional help numbers appear on 6B.

Across America, shock and fear coalesce into a desire for revenge. **5A**

Reporter Bart Jansen finds disbelief, sorrow and anger in Washington. **5A**

The Taliban denies that Osama bin Laden had anything to do with Tuesday's events. **7A**

Television and newspapers scramble to tell the story as unbelievable events unfold. **8A**

Rescue crews prepare for the painful task of recovering bodies, including their friends. **9A**

Shortly before a plane crashes into the Pentagon, Defense Secretary Donald Rumsfeld predicts terrorism against America. **10A**

Millions of New Yorkers are stranded as transportation shuts down. Others flee the city on foot or by boat. **10A**

Members of Maine's congressional delegation are confident that justice will prevail. **10A**

Air travelers in Maine scramble to find alternate transportation. **11A**

Incredulous Mainers express fear at the scale of Tuesday's terrorist attacks. **1B**

Maine's generosity is evident as residents flock to



The Associated Press

Worshippers at First Baptist Church in Portland, including David Murphy of Old Orchard Beach, front, pray Tuesday evening. Story, 2B

donate blood to attack victims. **Bill Nemitz, 1B**

Gov. King briefs reporters on emergency preparations in Maine. **3B**

Oil terminals in Portland Harbor are shut down for security reasons. **6C**

Business activity in Maine nearly grinds to a halt. **6C**

Pro, college and high school sports teams put play on hold. **1D**

INDEX

Abby	5C
Business	6C
Classified	5D
Comics	4C
Deaths	7B
Editorials	12A
Flip Side	12D
Horoscope	5C
Landers	5C
Legals	5D
Lottery	2A
People	12D
Sports	1D
Television	5C
Theaters	3C

